

the 1990s, the number of people in the world who are under 15 years of age has increased from 1.1 billion to 1.5 billion, and the number of people aged 65 and over has increased from 0.2 billion to 0.4 billion (United Nations, 1999).

There are a number of reasons why the world population is growing so rapidly. One of the main reasons is that the number of children born to each woman has increased. This is due to a number of factors, including improved medical care, increased access to contraception, and a shift in cultural values. In many parts of the world, children are now seen as a source of labour and income, rather than as a burden.

Another reason for the rapid growth of the world population is that the number of people who are surviving into old age has increased. This is due to a number of factors, including improved medical care, increased access to health care, and a shift in cultural values. In many parts of the world, old age is now seen as a time of life, rather than a time of hardship.

The rapid growth of the world population has a number of implications for the future. One of the main implications is that there will be a need for more resources, such as food, water, and energy. This will put pressure on the environment and on the world's economies. It will also mean that there will be a need for more people to work, which will put pressure on the world's education systems.

There are a number of ways in which the world population can be managed more sustainably. One way is to reduce the number of children born to each woman. This can be done by increasing access to contraception and by shifting cultural values. Another way is to improve the health care of the elderly, so that they can live longer and healthier lives.

The world population is growing rapidly, and this has a number of implications for the future. It is important that we take steps to manage the world population more sustainably, so that we can ensure a better future for all.

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